Dragon’s Den

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/65482684.

Rating:
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Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra)

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Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Angella (She-Ra)

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Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence, Bad Parent Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), POV Glimmer (She-Ra), POV Angella (She-Ra), Mass Death, Politics, Minor Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Alternate Universe - Dark, Dark Adora (She-Ra), Dark Catra (She-Ra), Character Death, its just Shadow Weaver so it doesn’t count honestly

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English

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Part 5 of The Crimson Star

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by HeyTorWrites

Summary

Glimmer goes against her Mother’s wishes once again to sneak out and help with the war effort. As always, she drags Bow along with a small Battalion of soldiers to fight the Horde and hopefully gain another victory for the Rebellion.

That day, Glimmer and Bow find She-ra waiting for them and invites her into their ranks.

Ps: This is the 5th thing I’ve written for The Crimson Star (only realized recently how that sounds like a Crimson Waste Au sorry about that-) but if I was writing in order this would have been the very first chapter.

Notes

Don’t ask me why the spacing is so weird I’ve tried to fix it and it messes up every time I hate it just as much as you do 😩

See the end of the work for more notes

Shadow Weaver was a cruel woman, she'd tell you that herself.

The Witch had spent years perfecting her craft in all that was War and Magic and she took advantage at any minute opportunity that she could take from those around her.

Broken families, dead parents, orphaned kids, massacred villages, homeless and injured victims of the Horde's war machines, all of them were mere necessities. Even a delight sometimes when certain groups of people gave her more trouble than they were worth, which happened to be most groups in her eyes.

Weaver had also gotten good at molding those around her over time, a dark talent that she kept hidden in her Arsenal. This skill had shown itself in the form of two children she had raised in her youth and her first couple of years in the Horde, a young Mage and a Small Magicat.

Both disappointed her in the end, so they had to be scrapped and she started over. As one does with failed projects.

And not once in all her years had she felt an ounce of regret for any of it.

Now, the third stands before her in the image of a Beast. The Creature holds a sword over her head that was soon to be heading straight through her skull. She had already been slashed by its now bloody blade and thrown against the wall that she's now laid against as she crumpled into a pile of red and black on the floor.

Except it wasn't really her, the skin was white like Adora, the hair golden. But those eyes were blue, yellow, and surrounded by red as they zeroed in on her slumped form, unmoving. The fur that

was an overwhelming presence on most of the 8 foot tall body and the slim tail that was a strange mix of black and gold told The Commander everything she needed to know.

Cold spills into her veins as The Figure that should've been impossible stood in front of her with a wide grin and shook with nearly giddy excitement as the blood spilled from the sword's tip and onto the smaller woman's chest.

For the first time in perhaps her entire life Shadow Weaver wondered,

Was this her fault?

— — — — — —

Thump

Thump

Thump

Thump drops each leather sole of iron layered boots side by side as they march their way through trees and bushes.

Jingle rings their armory emblazoned with Brightmoon's Sigil as it rocks on their rushing bodies and heaving chests,

This was a company of soldiers under Rebellion rein heading their way to a conflict site that they had been waiting on standby to join since the other Battalion had left out that morning. It was supposed to be a couple of hours before they set out but a radio in from one of their scouts frantically reported that there was an ambush and that they needed immediate reinforcements.

Ahead of them runs The Princess and Master Archer Bow as they lead them towards their destination, the former grounded and going against direct order yet still determined and the latter concerned yet prepared.

"This is the Conflict Point?" Glimmer asks as she looks to her right.

A man with the brown of bark in his hair, silver in his eyes and wrinkle lines around the edges of his face nods as he loads the Brightmoon sigiled rifle in his hands, "Yes, right up ahead Princess. We should be entering it now"

"Good" The pink haired young woman responds. The thrum that pumps through her veins every time she's near a fight starts to heat up her chest and shapes her lips into a grin as sparks start to crackle on her fingertips, "Bow?"

An arrow is knocked from his Quiver and lined with the string of his Bow, “Ready.”

She turns back to what was awaiting them up ahead, “Then let’s go.”

The rally of soldiers follow their Princess and their limbs tighten and their jaws tense with the knowledge and anticipation of the blood that was soon to be spilled, the families soon to be broken, the gunpowder waiting to be unleashed and blades ready to be swung.

They were ready to fight for their homes, for their families, for their dignity, and the soon to be freedom and healing of Etheria once the scum squirming in its hold is wiped and cleaned out from every crack and crevice and hidden corner of the land.

They rush as one with stomping feet as they click their rifles and unsheathe their weapons and they all hitch their breath when they ram through the leaves and they’re met with-

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Silence.

Not a single yell. No orders. No fire. No rings of metal.

Just bodies.

Laid across the ground as a long mass and mimicking the sea as corpse after corpse lay across one another in a limp stillness that chokes the entire area and pins it into a place of grey melancholy as the branches cast black shadows over the field of dead.

The stench rolls off the still fresh skin and wafts from their spilled blood as it drips through their clothes and soaks the grass blades to infest the soil. Horde and Brightmoon sigils alike are left forgotten and torn on still chests and stuck open eyelids as they too are soaked red with the tainted liquid.

Not a single soldier stands to greet them. The breath had been ripped from every throat, the beat crushed out of every heart, Friend or foe.

Silence.

The magic that had been glowing in Glimmer's hands fizzles out with her confusion as she steps closer to the bloodbath, "Battalion Commander Shiloh, how long ago did you get that Radio in…?"

"About an hour before we headed out, it sounded like the fight was in full swing when we got the call" The officer responds, sounding as baffled as she looked as his rifle is now held loosely in his hands.

"Don't worry, you didn't miss much"

The group turns to look at the source of the voice that had rung out into the quiet expanse of the Dead. It echoes, a repeat of itself that shakes the skull and demands attention, low in nature yet loud with its reach.

What they see are eyes. Two blue eyes with pupil's that glow gold and golden rings around the irises as if it had melted into their Sclera and made its home there.

"Who are you…?" The Princess blurts out, having to tilt her head up up at the raised earth the eyes were staring at them from.

"Hopefully…a soon to be friend" The Stranger moves forward and reveals some of themself from the shade.

Their size rises to ten feet as their head blends with the branches. It was wide with tan skin and blonde fur on the sides of their chin. Two teeth stick out of their lips, sharp and thick as they point out like tusks. Golden hair hung from their head and rested on their shoulders like a Royal Mane crowning their scalp.

Their torso shines with armor white as The Kingdom of Snows across their chest and shoulders but stops at their arms, allowing specks of fur to peak from the skin of sculpted biceps until it stops at the gold laced bracelets on their steel mimicking wrists. Their hands are large and taunt with pad-like palms that twitch at their sides as a ring encrusted in gold shines on their middle finger with a teal stone embedded in its center.

Their black pants lined with plated armor across their legs and heavy boots made of silver and tipped in gold that spread to their soles. Long fabric blankets along their back and shoulders with a rose red cape with yellow edges that draped over the width of their body and mixed them with the shadows and covered the long Woolly tail tapping the ground behind them with intrigue.

This person was covered in blood.

Every bit of them is painted with splatters of red that drips down their chest and falls to their legs until it makes a mess of a puddle on the floor. From the muscles down to the colors of their outfit this Thing was built to topple and crush, to raise the ground under it and reshape the world anew. This Thing…this creature.

“You’re…She-ra”

How else could someone like this exist?

The Figure turns to look at her directly now, "Oh? So you've heard of…" they seem to stop, the colors in their eyes twirling and spinning in a haze before righting themselves again;

"Me?" They finish as they rest their chin on a closed fist, it seems as if she caught their attention.

"Of course we do, everyone has!" Bow adds from his spot next to his best friend, "She-ra is a legend, the one who'll save all of Etheria!" He beams.

They…She-ra, tilts her head and bends at a weird angle before crouching where she stands and smiling, "That does sound like me yes" she giggles.

"This is great! Mom will-"

Ahem

Glimmer turns to look at Shiloh as he clears his throat, the shock of The Legend's appearance not over weighing the eeriness of the bodies pouring a pool of blood under their feet.

The reminder immediately dampens her expression.

"So…what happened here?" She cringes.

She-ra's eyes raise up and their gaze runs over the Splatter of flesh, "Hm, I couldn't tell you how it started, most of these had already fallen before I arrived. But I can tell you how it ended," She sits up before she looks back down at them, it was hard to see the rest of her face under the dimness of the leaves.

"When I got here the fighting was in full swing, your soldiers were outnumbered and the enemy were pushing them further back into the forest. It was clear that if I didn't do something soon that they wouldn't survive long enough to retreat so I helped. As you can see…" A bulky hand raises and points at the carnage behind them, "I didn't succeed in saving them but I took out all that I could." The hand returns to her chin, "Though I must say it's hard to focus when you're being shot and stabbed in the back by the people you're trying to save"

"It's not everyday someone like you comes along, you can't blame them for being scared" Bow frowns.

"Of course, It didn't do them much good in the end though" Her chest rises and falls in a hefty sigh but her focus quickly returns to The Princess, "Your powers, they're stunted aren't they?"

"What?" Glimmer's eyes widen and her face scrunches in confusion, her boot pressing down wet grass blades as she takes a step back.

"I can feel it, your magic" Her tail flickers and she gestures to her ring with a smile, "I'm Magic too. We're brethren, you're a Princess just as I am"

Stone cracks and groans as The Giant stands and bright light starts at her chest before spreading to the rest of her body. She jumps, shrinking the more it continues to brighten and spread around her until she reaches the ground with a-

Thump

The light gives away to a much smaller woman of around 6 feet tall, her hair blonde and straight with indigo blue eyes that shimmer when she lifts her head to look at them. The woman stumbles and she looks discontented, her gazy foggy as if she was missing something. A Giant transforming to a normal size is quite the shift, anyone would struggle to catch their bearings.

She stables and offers her hand, "Hi, I'm Adora. I think we're going to do Great Things together"

Glimmer smiles as she shakes her hand, "Hi! I'm Glimmer, this is Bow" She glances at him and he puts his arrow back in his Quiver to wave, by the time she looks back she's grinning, "My Mom is going to love you"

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Gloved fingers rub against the smooth skin of a tired face as Angella leans into the back of her throne.

Her Daughter had snuck out again.

The Horde has had them scrambling to defend themselves as the Front Line gets pushed further and further back, each plot of land they lost meant they were another step closer to Brightmoon's gates falling. Wrangling the nobles, calming the people, and funding the supplies for the troops was enough to strain her back on its own but single handedly raising a child had nearly broken it.

She knew that Glimmer understood the concept of danger, the problem was that she chased after it. She was old enough to join the war effort but running face first into possible death at every opportunity was only putting her at risk and causing her Mother even more stress on top of everything else that she didn't need at the moment.

The guards had just finished informing her that The Princess had returned and that she had asked them to tell her that she had come home with a "surprise". The pair had looked shocked and frazzled as they spoke to their Queen, clearly struggling to maintain their focus as they gave their report. Whatever the young woman had brought with her was probably going to give her a headache.

Another pair of Guards walk out into the center of the room and bow, “She has arrived My Queen” The left one announces.

“Send her in”

They nod and go back the way they came, making way for Glimmer as she enters The Throne Room with Bow on her heel. Her smile is far too wide for someone who was supposed to be in her room right now as the both of them kneel, “You’re Majesty” They greet in unison.

Angella takes in a long breath through her nose and speaks once she lets it out, “Glimmer, I felt as if I was very clear when I told you that you were *not* to leave the castle walls”

The formalities are dropped rather quickly after that, “Look, Mom, I know you’re mad at me but hear me out-”

“Glimmer…”

“Just listen! I promise it’s good. Just let me explain and you can reground me or whatever later” The Princess offers, waving her hand carelessly even as she begins to bounce on her feet.

Well, whatever had her so excited should at least be something worthwhile, but still…

The Queen shifts her gaze to Bow just to find him nodding and giving her a double thumbs up, “Continue…” She says slowly.

"So me and Bow went out to help fight in the forest in that area next to Alwyn but when we got there our forces were…." She pauses.

"Massacred" Bow adds hesitantly.

"What!?"

"But! The Horde didn't get away either! That's where the surprise comes in" Glimmer interrupts.

She'd have to address the amount of casualties with the Commander later, "And what's the surprise…?"

Loud footfalls echo from outside, getting louder as they near the Throne room. The heads of the Royal Guards turn and Angella sits up at the sound as it gets closer.

Glimmer and Bow step back to make space as they gesture their hands, "Ta Da!" Glimmer continues, "Mom, meet-"

"She-ra…" Angella finishes in a whisper.

The Legend herself steps into the Center of the room in all of her glory, clean and pristine as she nods in acknowledgment and greets, “Queen Angella”

The Queen stands and as she does the clacks of her Guards straightening their postures echoes throughout the wide space.

Her steps are careful as she descents down the stairs, not being able to hide her shock as she looks at the three of them “The Legend of The First Ones spoke of a Being of Power called She-ra, they said she would come to save us with Otherworldly strength and Gentle hands. I never thought she was anything other than a Myth, and yet you’ve walked into my Castle to stand before me like a Living Miracle” she admits as she makes Eye Contact with The Wonder standing across from her, “She-ra, Princess of Power. The Rebellion has never needed you as much as it does now, do you Pledge to serve the Rebellion in the Fight against The Evil Horde to the best of your ability?”

“No.” She says simply, hearing the sound of her voice for the first time rattles many of the members inside the room.

Glimmer and Bow startle at The Giant’s knees and look up in shock, “What?!”

“No…?” Angella questions carefully.

She-ra raises her palm in peace, "I mean no Disrespect Your Majesty, but I am of the opinion that it is *unfair* to the People for me to align myself solely to the likes of the Rebellion"

"But everyone is a part of the Rebellion! Everyone that matters-" The Princess starts before being silenced by a look from her Mother.

This was…troublesome. If she was going to combat what they asked of her the very first time they came face to face, what other issues would she cause?

But they truly weren't in a position to deny her, so she nods, "Explain"

"I was created to serve and protect, that goes to everyone on Etheria. The unknown, the unwanted, and anyone that needs me. Pledging to the Rebellion would be a betrayal to the people who find hope in what She-ra represents for them. A pure force of good that doesn't work under an Agenda or for a gain." She speaks easily, her words steady and sure as she addresses the Royalty in the room.

A light shines from one of her fingers and clanks against the ground as The Sword of protection steadies in the hold of both of her hands, "I Hereby Pledge to the whole of Etheria and its Inhabitants. I propose an Allyship to The Rebellion and I Swear to offer my sword when I am needed and if I am able"

All is quiet for a moment.

It wasn't…unreasonable. While she preferred that someone with such strength be held close and monitored, she understood that this was the only choice they had if they wanted This Being on their side. There were always negotiations and propositions to be made at a later date but for now…

"We will accept your offer, Welcome Princess She-ra, Ally of The Rebellion"

Cheers erupt immediately, clapping and chanting as The New Savior is welcomed with open arms and she kneels so Glimmer and Bow can reach for and hug her, laughing with their Joy for the new surely to be brighter days to come.

She should feel relieved, the answers to all of their problems just *appeared* on their doorstep and offered her help. With the power of The Sword of Protection the War would be a breeze compared to the typhoon it had been for decades and all of this would be over soon.

But as she watches The Giant smile and laugh with her Daughter with the Sword still standing upright in her firm grip she can't help but feel a creeping doubt that this *wasn't* their Savior.

But maybe she was being too harsh, no one was perfect during their first times, not even Legends apparently.

She was right, this was certainly giving her a headache.

End Notes

You're all the probably very confused why this is a week late. First off, the parts I already had written were kind of outdated and needed to be changed to fit some minor narrative changes as well as the new writing perspective I'm going for. Not to mention the last but had to be added close to the deadline before I was supplied to post and it took longer than I thought it would.

So instead of posting a day late I decided to take the week to work on some short stories since after the next installment is posted next week I will be changing to a biweekly schedule since they next couple of fics/chapters will take longer to write and the plan is to post these short stories in between those two week breaks.

I will be trying to use my inactive twitter account so instead of making you guys wait a week for answers if something like this happens again I'll update y'all there. Also, for people who don't like to comment who might still want to interact with me or ask me questions. The @ is @HeyItsTorLads on Twitter and I will be dropping the name of the next fic on there later.

Thank you for reading, and thank you for being patient I was going through a mental health crisis this week so editing this was kind of a struggle sorry if shit just doesn't make sense-

Happy Mother's Day!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!